global level in a more organised way. Recent developments with regard to India's regional trade agreements (RTAs) have been given below[19] –

SAFTA

The SAFTA (South Asia Free Trade Area) Agreement came into force on January 1, 2006 – under it, India has granted *zero basic custom* duty to all LDCs, viz. Afghanistan, Bangladesh, Bhutan, and Maldives, on all items except 25 items relating to alcohol and tobacco. Under the SAFTA Agreement, India has reduced the SAFTA Sensitive List for non-LDCs from 878 to 614 by reduction of 264 tariff lines from 6 September 2012. As per the schedule of Tariff Liberalisation Programme (TLP) under SAFTA, India has brought down its peak tariff rates to ***5 per cent from January 1, 2013***.

EHS

India-Thailand FTA, *Early Harvest Scheme* (EHS) under the Framework Agreement for establishing India-Thailand FTA was signed on 9th October 2003, which includes trade in goods, trade in services, investment, and other areas of economic cooperation, to be concluded as a single undertaking. Under EHS, tariff has gradually been eliminated on a list of 82 common items simultaneously by both sides between September 1, 2004 and August 31, 2006. Under the India-Thailand FTA, it is proposed to provide ASEAN plus tariff concessions. So far 26 rounds of the India-Thailand Trade Negotiation Committee (ITTNC) meetings have been held. The last round was held on November 26–27, 2012 in New Delhi.

CECA

India-ASEAN Comprehensive Economic Cooperation Agreement (CECA) Services and Investment Agreements was signed on August 13, 2009 under the broader framework of the CECA between India and ASEAN which has already come into force. Conclusions of negotiations for the Services Agreement and Investment Agreement have been announced during the ASEAN-India Commemorative Summit held on *December 20, 2012* in